PLAYER REPORT

RYUNOSUKE SATO

POSITION: LEFT MIDFIELDER

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Games Watched:
- FC Tokyo played 3-0 Yokohama F. Marinos

Minutes Watched: 80 Minutes
Date: 27.03.2026

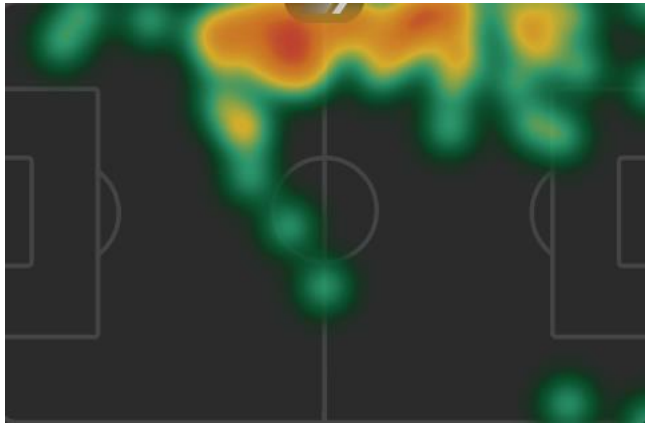
OVERALL SUMMARY

- Ryunosuke Sato is a 19-year-old left midfielder who plays for FC Tokyo.
- He has good spatial awareness, an expert ball progression, dribbling and forward link-up play.
- Sato is a self-assured, strong-willed individual and he is highly mobile during the game.
- Defensively, he has difficulties in dueling, positioning, and possession awareness.
- He has good prospects of being an attack-oriented midfielder with specific focus on developing in the areas of defense and physicality.

2026 STATS

- Total Games: 2
- Starting XI: 2
- Minutes: 154 (MW5)
- G/A: 1
- Discipline: 1YC

2026 HEAT MAP vs Yokohama F. Marinos



(FOTMOB)

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OFFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

BALL PROGRESSION

- **Progressive:** Sato takes up aggressive positions to be positioned to receive again and play at an advanced position with a forward-thinking attitude.
- **Dynamic:** A major strength is his ball carrying. He is able to fight through players without compromising without resorting to slow dribbling and speed, passing the ball to the team using close passes.
- **Visionary:** Sato can identify progressive passing in the forward direction, such as long progressive passes that facilitate rapid transition and offensive build-ups.

BALL RETENTION

- **Ball Security:** Sato's initial touch is usually clean and controlled even when under pressure and thus is able to stabilize possession and prepare to take action.
- **Press-Resistance:** Sato is able to come out of tight situation, he can beat an opponent with that close control and dribbling before he continues with the play.
- **Composure:** Although he is cool in narrow spaces, there are occasions when he can lose it in moments making decisions under pressure, and he can work on being calm at all times.

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OFFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

MOVEMENT TO RECEIVE

- **Intelligence:** Sato is always able to create some pockets of space amongst the lines and especially on the left side he enjoys the most.
- **Anticipation:** He is highly anticipative, reading the ball path and the movement of his teammate early so that he can get there in time to receive without disrupting the rhythm of his team.
- **Availability:** His off-ball activity is not variable. He also carries out a lot of supportive runs to offer options in possession and sustain constant feeling of flow in attack.

FINAL THIRD IMPACT

- **Creative:** He plays in the higher levels effectively by linking up, playing well with other team members and creating attacking patterns.
- **Threatening:** Sato has good shooting instinct and is sure of himself 1v1, he is thus a direct attacking threat when in close range.
- **Supportive:** His runs into the box and forward provides a new option in attack, but his frequency and intensity of such runs would make him a greater threat.

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DEFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

DYNAMIC PRESSING

- **Energetic:** Sato is willing to push and will be involved in the recovery of possession, particularly at transitional times.
- **Responsive:** His fast reaction to turnovers enables him to put a lot of pressure as soon as it happens, and this helps to break the rhythm of the opponent.
- **Disruptive:** He is able to make errors by forcing using pressing and intelligent movement and therefore he is effective during defensive high energy phases.

DEFENSIVE DUELING

- **Reactive:** Sato responds swiftly when he loses control of the ball, and in many cases, he tries to get back the ball or rectify errors in positioning.
- **Limited:** He has physical impairments that impair his performance in duels, especially air and shoulder-to-shoulder duels.
- **Developing:** The ability to develop technique and timing is not yet consistently developed, which is why the defensive fundamentals have to be enhanced.

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DEFENSIVE COMPETENCIES

POSITIONAL DEFENDING

- **Awareness:** Sato reads the game, and is able to predict opposition movement, which reinforces his pressing and recovery movement.
- **Inconsistency:** His defensive tactics, particularly when taking set pieces, may not be consistent and there may be gaps or can expose the team.
- **Improving:** He understands the team's defensive structure, spacing, and compactness, but he must improve to enhance better contribution, without the ball.

MENTALITY & PHYSICAL OUTPUT

- **Confidence:** Sato plays with confidence, especially in situations of attack, i.e. dribbling, shooting and moving the ball.
- **Resilience:** He positively responds to errors, and sometimes has to bounce back very fast and keep contributing without a second thought.
- **Active:** Sato's mobility and work rate are good, he is able to move around and engage in the game, but physical strength is something he needs to work on.

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INVESTMENT

- Sato is a young talent of high potential (19) with great technical skills, attacking intelligence and flexibility.
- His ball progression, dribbling, and link-up play attributes can be considered as a valuable developmental asset to the teams that want to have creative midfield solutions.
- Although there are defensive restrictions, they can be addressed by specific coaching, which means that he is a long-term investment with an upside.

STRATEGIC FIT

- Sato is best suited in teams that place an emphasis on possession based, progressive attacking play, in a role such as central midfielder (8), advanced midfielder (AM), or a wide support (left flank).
- He complements teams needing pressure-resistant, futuristic midfielders who are capable of keeping pace, setting up passing paths and aiding swift turnover.
- Clubs that want to have a high-tempo, possession-based style will find it beneficial to integrate him and then work on his defensive awareness and physicality.

RECOMMENDATION

- As a developmental player focus on offensive integration and provide mentorship and defensive training programs.
- Suitable where the club aims at domestic and continental expansion and invests in young technically endowed talent.